

Lon worked in the federal government for several years before becoming a big supporter of his son's case.

the office on September 11, 2001, he was listening to the radio as the first plane hit the World Trade Center during the terrorist attacks. Similar to many Americans, the event changed his life. As the Iraq War (2003–2011) unfolded, Snowden was caught up in patriotic fervor and wanted to help free the Iraqi people from oppression. In 2004, Snowden volunteered for the US Army Special Forces. But during training, he broke both of his legs in an accident and was discharged a few months later.

In need of a job, Snowden passed a lie-detector test and rigorous background check and landed a position as a security guard at the University of Maryland. While attending a job fair, he spoke to a representative from

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